



北京大学

Assignment 1

第一次个人作业

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Review of "Effective Data Storytelling: How to Drive Change with Data, Narrative and Visuals" by Brent Dykes.

In Brent Dykes' seminal work, "Effective Data Storytelling: How to Drive Change with Data, Narrative and Visuals," the author delves into the intricate art and science of transforming data into compelling narratives that not only inform but also inspire action. Dykes adeptly demonstrates that in today's economy, the ability to communicate effectively with data is not merely advantageous but imperative.

The book presents a comprehensive exploration of the fundamental elements of data storytelling, comprising data, narrative, and visuals, elucidating how to seamlessly integrate these components for maximum impact. Dykes argues persuasively for the primacy of narratives over raw statistics, contending that narratives possess a unique power to influence decisions and catalyze change.

One of the central tenets of the book is the concept of insight as a catalyst for change. Dykes posits that true insight arises from a fresh perspective on existing information, transcending mere facts to engender a deeper understanding. Drawing from psychological principles, he highlights the indispensable role of emotion in communication, asserting that narratives, which marry logic with emotion, are far more effective in engaging the human mind than plain data.

Structured into nine chapters, the book meticulously guides readers through the process of crafting impactful data stories tailored to specific audiences. Dykes draws upon a rich tapestry of historical anecdotes and modern examples to illustrate his points, seamlessly blending theory with practical insights. Notably, he pays homage to overlooked figures in the realm of data visualization, such as Florence Nightingale, whose pioneering work revolutionized sanitary reforms and saved countless lives.

Anchored in a four-step storyboarding process, Dykes elucidates how to structure data narratives to culminate in a revelatory "aha moment." Furthermore, he delves into the nuances of selecting and adapting visualizations to enhance comprehension and engagement, cautioning against pitfalls such as confirmation bias and spurious correlations.

While the book's primary focus is on communication skills and techniques, Dykes underscores the importance of rigorous data analysis as the bedrock of effective storytelling. He cautions against the manipulation of data to fit preconceived narratives, emphasizing the need for integrity and accuracy in data representation.

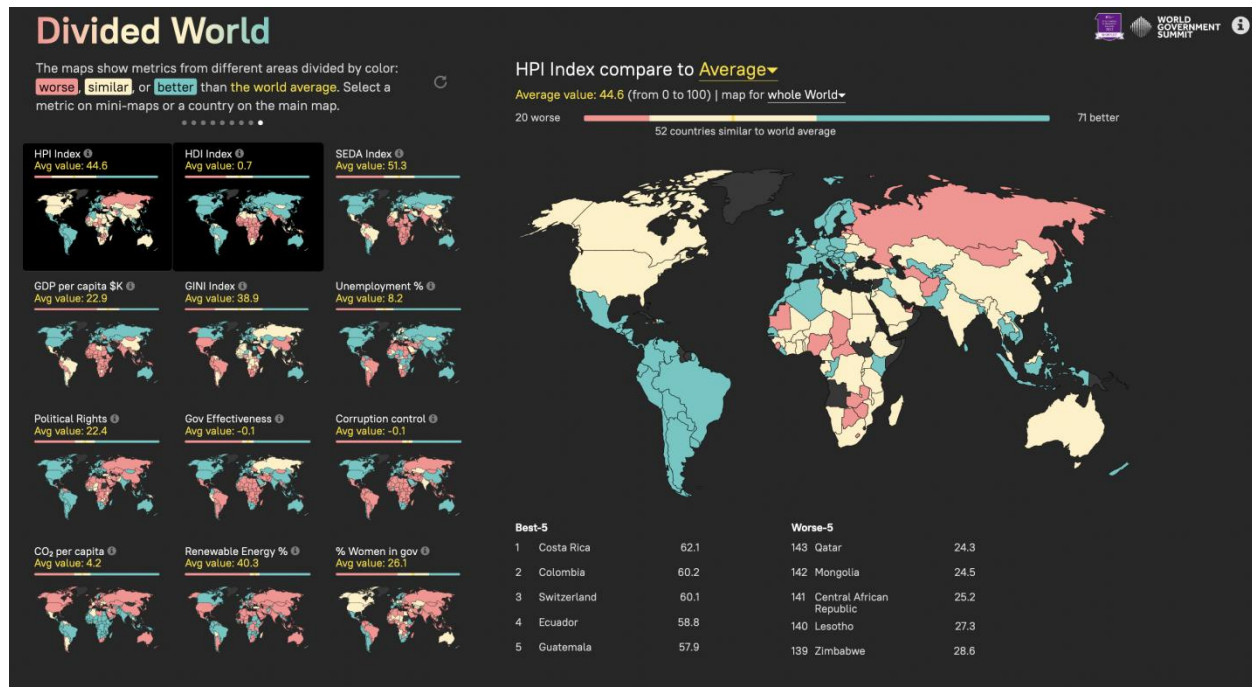
Throughout the narrative, Dykes demonstrates a masterful command of storytelling techniques, employing simple yet evocative visuals and narratives to underscore his arguments. While occasionally prone to simplistic argumentation, the book remains a valuable resource for professionals across diverse fields, from business and finance to education and science.

In conclusion, "Effective Data Storytelling" is a tour de force that marries the art of storytelling with the science of data, offering readers a roadmap to transform insights into action. By

embracing the triad of data, narrative, and visuals, Dykes equips practitioners with the tools they need to navigate the complex terrain of data communication and drive meaningful change.

Storytelling project 1

This is the storytelling project on www.revealthedata.com which is called “Divided World”.



The dynamic graph under scrutiny comprises nine pages, each showcasing a variety of indices such as the HPI index, HDI index, and SEDA index, among others. In its presentation, the graph exhibits commendable numeracy by incorporating numerical values, both in terms of average values and the values of ten countries, scaled from 0 to 100. Further enhancing its communicative efficacy is the judicious use of literacy, substituting verbose sentences with succinct keywords for clarity and conciseness.

Aesthetic considerations are not neglected in this visualization, as evidenced by the author's discerning employment of a restrained color palette, comprising merely three hues. This parsimony extends to the choice of text font, which, in conjunction with the black background, confers a polished and uncluttered aesthetic appeal upon the graph, fostering a conducive environment for data absorption and comprehension.

Three pivotal elements converge to elevate the efficacy of this visualization:

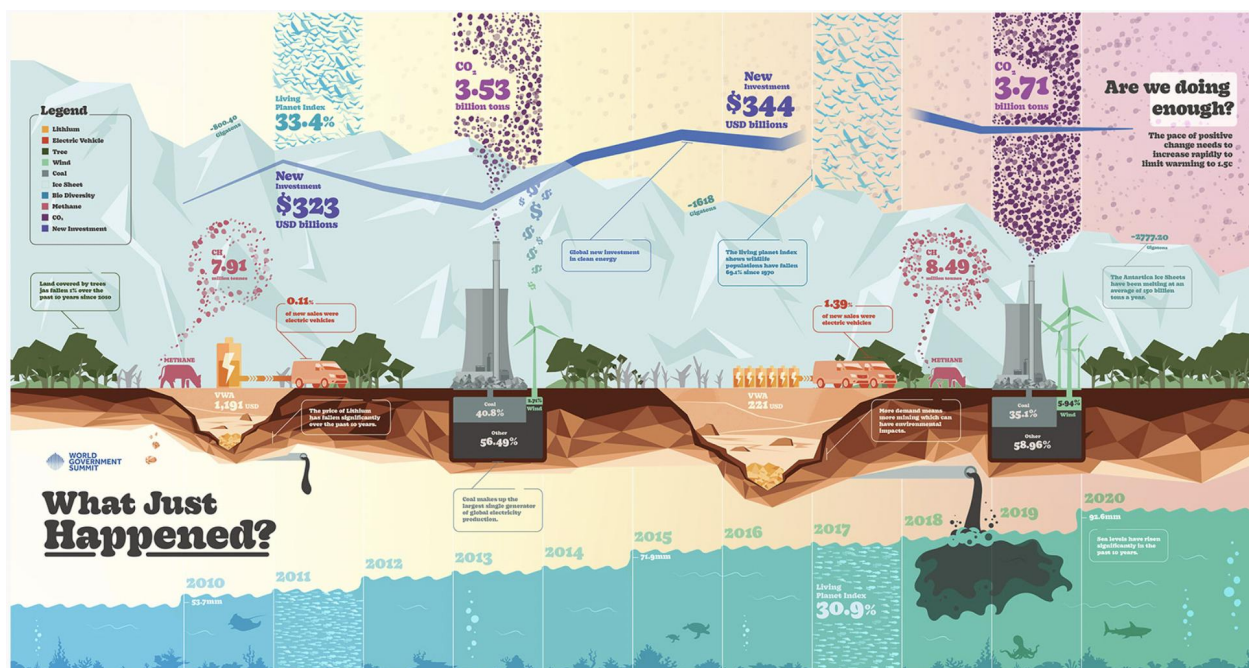
Firstly, the graph excels in elucidating the content of data storytelling, offering a lucid portrayal that enables users to readily discern the premier and inferior performers across each index, thereby fostering a nuanced understanding of the data landscape.

Secondly, while the focal point of this visualization may not squarely rest on storytelling per se, its inherent capacity to engage users is nonetheless notable. By presenting independent indicators with clarity and precision, the graph captivates attention and incites curiosity, thereby engendering an environment ripe for exploration and interpretation.

Lastly, the graph admirably facilitates the extraction of key insights within the data storytelling content through its visualizations. By affording a comprehensive overview of twelve sub-plots' average values in a single glance, the graph facilitates efficient comprehension, enabling users to swiftly discern and internalize salient information without undue cognitive burden.

In summation, the dynamic graph under scrutiny emerges as a commendable exemplar of effective data visualization, characterized by its intuitive design, judicious use of numeracy and literacy, and aesthetic finesse. While its primary focus may lie in presenting independent indicators, its inherent capacity to engage users and facilitate insight extraction renders it a valuable asset in the arsenal of data storytellers and analysts alike.

Storytelling project 2



This captivating infographic amalgamates data from esteemed sources including NASA, the IPCC, and the World Bank, meticulously crafted by Jamie Harris and Linaka Greensword.

Numeracy is intricately woven into this visualization, manifested through the adept utilization of numerical representations encompassing years, USD values, and indicators of consumption.

In the realm of literacy, the authors exhibit a masterful command, elucidating each significant event succinctly in a single sentence. This deliberate approach ensures clarity and comprehension for the discerning reader. Furthermore, the judicious placement of the

visualization's title in the lower left corner serves as a beacon, guiding the viewer through the narrative labyrinth.

Aesthetic finesse permeates the composition, as the authors deftly employ a harmonious palette of colors. The azure and verdant hues symbolize the boundless depths of the sea, while the earthy tones of brown and yellow evoke the terrestrial realm. Notably, vibrant hues accentuate pivotal textual elements, enhancing visual engagement.

Three pivotal elements converge to elevate the efficacy of this visualization:

Firstly, a discerning consideration for F-shaped browsing users is evident, with the strategic positioning of the Legend on the left flank. This thoughtful placement ensures immediate comprehension, facilitating seamless navigation through the intricacies of the data.

Secondly, the infusion of visually arresting elements, such as the ethereal bubble background enveloping the numerical annotations, imbues the visualization with an aura of enchantment. Moreover, the dynamic representation of the annual rise in sea level captivates the viewer, fostering immersive engagement with the narrative unfolding.

Lastly, the essence of environmental consciousness pervades the fabric of this visualization, transcending linguistic barriers to deliver a poignant message. Indeed, the adage "A picture is worth a thousand words" finds resonance here, as the imagery evokes a visceral understanding of the imperatives surrounding environmental stewardship.

In essence, this meticulously crafted visualization transcends mere data representation, emerging as a veritable tapestry of insights, beckoning the viewer to contemplate the intricate interplay of human endeavor and planetary well-being.